

Integration	Queue / Event Bus	Key Deciding Factor
Settlement command	Queue	Exactly-once processing by a single consumer; retries required without duplication or loss.
Payment received broadcast	Event Bus	Multiple independent consumers need the same event simultaneously (fan-out).
SMS / push notifications	Queue	One worker per message with load balancing across competing consumers.
Fraud score request	Queue	1-to-1 request/reply communication; response intended for a single consumer only.
Account state change events	Event Bus	State changes must be broadcast to many services, with future subscribers supported.
End-of-day reconciliation	Queue	Task distribution where each job is processed by exactly one worker, with retries.

Choose a Queue when:

- One consumer should process the message.
- It is a command, task, or work item.
- Load balancing across workers is required.
- Retries and guaranteed processing are important.
- Request-reply (1-to-1) communication is needed.

Choose an Event Bus when:

- Multiple consumers need the same message.
- The message represents an event or state change.
- Fan-out (publish-subscribe) is required.
- New subscribers may be added in the future without changing the publisher.